

Picking the right words

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION USES VARIED AND APPROPRIATE VOCABULARY.

It's important to pick words that are clear and suit the purpose and audience of the text. Using the same words all the time can be boring, so try to use a varied range of vocabulary.

SEE ALSO

◀ 26–27	Adjectives
◀ 84–85	Idioms, analogies, and figures of speech
◀ 86–87	Colloquialisms and slang
Genre, purpose, and audience	190–191 ▶
Writing to inform	196–197 ▶
Newspaper articles	198–199 ▶
Writing to describe	208–209 ▶
Writing for the Web	214–215 ▶

Avoid overused words

Using a wide range of vocabulary makes a piece of writing more entertaining and original. Here are some overused words to avoid, such as *got* and *great*, and some alternatives, known as synonyms.



- **Look up** any **new** words and find out what they mean. Then, write them down and try to use them in the **future**.

Less is more

It's important not to use several words when one will do. Overly long phrases might seem impressive, but they are often unclear. Most long phrases can be replaced with shorter versions.

REAL WORLD

Military jargon

Members of the armed forces use jargon to communicate with one another for speed and secrecy. Many of these terms are abbreviations of longer phrases. For example, *DPV* is an abbreviation for "Desert Patrol Vehicle."



Unclear version

she is of the opinion that
concerning the matter of
in the event that
regardless of the fact that
due to the fact that
in all cases
he is a man who
a small number of

Concise version

she thinks that
about
if
although
because
always
he
a few